Elizabeth Koch

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Active Secret Clearance (TS/SCI Sponsorship Eligible)

Professional Summary

Enterprise Product and Engineering Executive driving secure cloud modernization and product practice development across defense and federal environments, including the Department of the Air Force, U.S. Space Force, and Department of Veterans Affairs. Built and scaled Clarity Innovations' product management practice supporting 17 engineering teams in secure cloud environments. Engineering-fluent (Harvard CS; Python, JavaScript, React, SQL; AWS/GCP; CI/CD and DevSecOps), with a record of turning executive vision into outcome-based roadmaps and shipped capability under compliance and acquisition constraints.

Professional Experience

Clarity Innovations | Engineering Director, Product Management

July 2023 – Present

- Built and scaled the product management practice supporting **17 engineering teams** across secure cloud environments: standards, playbooks, PM coaching, and career development.
- Direct product strategy for **Cloud One DSOT** (formerly Operation Swift Shield), the Department of the Air Force's enterprise application modernization program, migrating Air Force applications to secure cloud infrastructure and onboarding COTS and mission applications through automated, security-scanned CI/CD pipelines under ATO constraints.
- Delivered **USSF Guardian One**, **cutting the Certificate to Field (CtF) timeline from the typical 90 days to 42**, through DAF software-factory infrastructure (BESPIN, Cantina CI/CD pipelines) under cATO compliance.
- Expanded the product portfolio by bringing in the **Space Force Portal** and led its platform transition from **Cloud One to Platform One**.
- Transitioned organizational reporting from activity-based tracking to outcome-focused performance indicators tied to cost efficiency and operational readiness.
- Designed governance and onboarding frameworks that accelerated secure system adoption while reducing operational overhead and compliance friction.
- Advise executive leadership on modernization strategy, risk alignment, and multi-million-dollar program investment prioritization.
- Institutionalized automation, observability, and secure-by-design practices across the product lifecycle.
- Built an **AI-driven product operating system** on Anthropic's Claude platform, with custom agentic skills, multi-perspective review agents, and automated workflows that standardize discovery, specs, prioritization, and stakeholder communication across the product practice; presented **"AI Confidence vs. AI Competence"** to the practice to set the bar for effective, responsible AI adoption in PM work.
- Presented **"Guardian One: Revolutionizing Capability Development in the U.S. Space Force"** at DAFITC 2024, the Department of the Air Force Information Technology and Cyberpower Conference.

Blue Tiger | Senior Product Manager, VA Identity Modernization (Login.gov)
September 2022 – June 2023

- Led modernization of the VA's authentication platform enabling secure digital access for **~15 million U.S. veterans**.
- Directed federated identity integration (Login.gov) across enterprise systems, coordinating engineering, security, and compliance stakeholders across multiple agencies.
- Defined reliability, adoption, and authentication success metrics; delivered iterative improvements that strengthened authentication reliability and reduced access-related service disruptions.

UKG / Ultimate Software
January 2010 – July 2022

Lead, Global Security Identity & Access Management

- Built and led the enterprise IAM function supporting global SaaS operations; developed the team through structured mentorship and performance management.
- Designed and implemented role-based access control across multi-product cloud environments; established governance frameworks improving access security, audit readiness, and operational efficiency.
- Served as senior advisor on identity risk, access policy, and compliance strategy.

Product Manager, Cloud Environment Services

- Conceived and delivered **"Clone Wars,"** an internal SaaS platform that replaced the sales team's manual VM-copy demo process with self-service provisioning: reps select the HCM products they need (recruiting, onboarding, or the full suite) and spin up a demo environment seeded with scrambled data **in minutes**, eliminating hours of manual environment setup per demo and the instability of locally copied VMs.
- Led cross-functional delivery of operational and platform initiatives for enterprise SaaS products.

Cineworks Digital Studios | Director of Information Technology
April 2004 – January 2010

- Directed global IT operations and infrastructure strategy; provided executive-level technology advisory supporting international expansion.

Education

Harvard University Extension School, Cambridge, MA

- Master of Liberal Arts (ALM), Digital Media Design, Expected May 2027, GPA 3.92
- Bachelor of Liberal Arts (ALB), Computer Science, May 2024, Cum Laude, GPA 3.6
- Graduate Certificates: Front-End Web Development, Back-End Web Development, Learning Design and Technology

Certifications & Skills

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  Clearance: Active Secret (TS/SCI sponsorship eligible)
- **Certifications:** Certified SAFe® 6 Product Owner/Product Manager | Certified Scrum Product Owner® (CSPO®) | Certified Incident Responder
- **Executive Leadership:** Product Organization Design | Digital Transformation | Governance & Risk Alignment | Executive Stakeholder Engagement | Cross-Functional Team Leadership

- **Product & Platform Strategy:** Product Lifecycle Leadership | Platform Modernization | User-Centered Design | DevSecOps Integration | Outcome-Based Roadmaps
- **AI & Agentic Systems:** Anthropic Claude / Claude Code | OpenAI ChatGPT | Agentic Workflow & Custom Skill Development | Multi-Agent Orchestration | AI-Assisted Product Operations
- **Cloud & Technical Fluency:** AWS | GCP | Identity & Access Management (IAM) | CI/CD | SQL | Python | JavaScript | React
- **Product & Collaboration Tools:** Atlassian Suite | Figma | Miro | FigJam | Lucidchart | Microsoft 365 | Google Workspace | Adobe Creative Cloud